Skill Builder Pack — IFS

Use SKILL 4E IFS and we will add a new column for results

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	student_name	Attendance Status	Delivery Mode	Engagement Score Weekly	Engagement Risk Band		
2	Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High		
3	Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High		
4	David Wilson	Present	On Campus	68	Medium		
5	Sarah Smith	Present	On Campus	82	Low		
6	James Taylor	Authorised Absence	On Campus	83	Low		
7	Lily Brown	Present	Remote	84	Low		
8	Emily Clark	Absent	On Campus	91	Low		
9	Daniel Green	Present	Hybrid	92	Low		
10	Sophia White	Present	Hybrid	65	Medium		
11	Lucas Hall	Present	Remote	76	Low		
12	Olivia King	Late	Remote	82	Low		
13	Henry Scott	Present	On Campus	83	Low		
14	Ava Turner	Present	On Campus	66	Medium		
15	Jack Hill	Present	Remote	63	Medium		
16	Mia Adams	Present	On Campus	86	Low		
17	Noah Baker	Present	Remote	82	Low		
18	Grace Nelson	Present	On Campus	93	Low		
19	Leo Carter	Present	On Campus	76	Low		
20	Ella Mitchell	Present	Remote	77	Low		
21	Oscar Perez	Present	Remote	56	High		
22	Isla Roberts	Present	Hybrid	84	Low		
23	Amelia Walker	Authorised Absence	On Campus	85	Low		
24	Ethan Phillips	Present	Hybrid	76	Low		
25	Freya Campbell	Present	Remote	69	Medium		
26	Benjamin Parker	Present	Remote	88	Low		
27	Chloe Evans	Present	On Campus	94	Low		
28	Arthur Edwards	Present	Hybrid	77	Low		
29	Sienna Collins	Present	Remote	78	Low		
30	Thomas Stewart	Present	Remote	79	Low		
31	Evie Morris	Absent	Hybrid	70	Medium		
32							
33							
34							

Key Idea

We are now answering:

> "If this is true do this, if not check something else…"

Instead of just one decision (IF), we now have **multiple possible outcomes**.

SECTION 1 — Understanding IFS

Structure:

```
=IFS(
condition1, result1,
condition2, result2,
condition3, result3
)
```

What this means:

1. Check the first condition
2. If true → stop and return result
3. If false → move to the next condition

Important:

Excel checks conditions **from top to bottom**

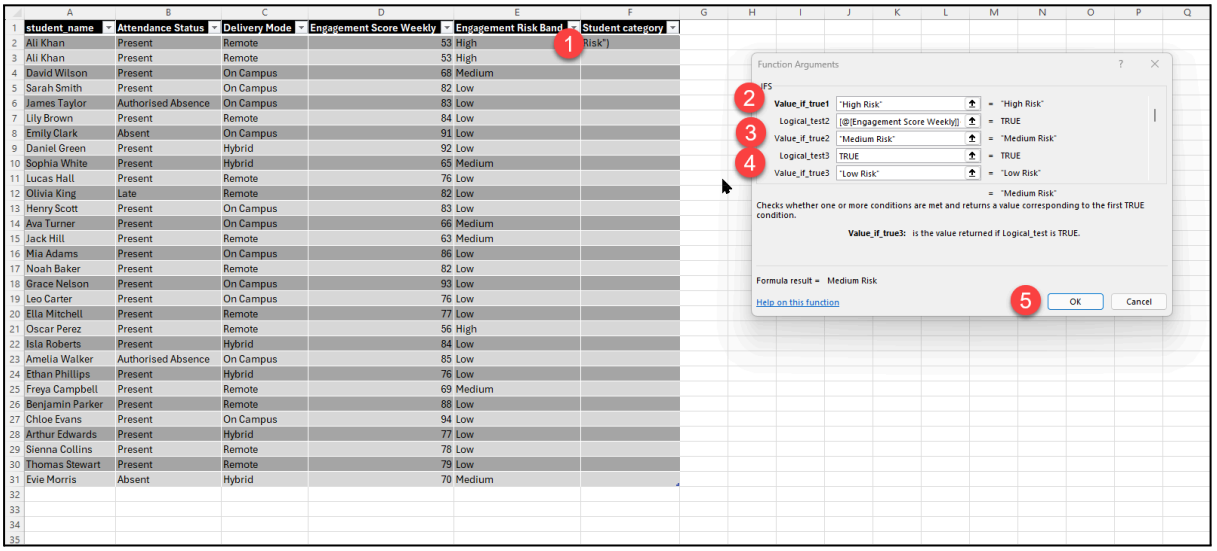
SECTION 2 — Simple IFS (based on score)

Question 1

Categorise students based on engagement score:

- Less than 50 → High Risk
- Less than 70 → Medium Risk
- Otherwise → Low Risk

What you do:



student_name	Attendance Status	Delivery Mode	Engagement Score Weekly	Engagement Risk Band	Student category
Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	
Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	
David Wilson	Present	On Campus	68	Medium	
Sarah Smith	Present	On Campus	82	Low	
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Sienna Collins	Present	Remote	78	Low	
Thomas Stewart	Present	Remote	79	Low	
Evie Morris	Absent	Hybrid	70	Medium	

1. Create a fresh column in column F called *Student category* and in cell D2, click to make it active, go to fx and look for IFS. Click on OK to open the Wizard
2. In **Logical_test1**, select cell E2 and use the conditional <50 and **Value_if_true** High Risk
3. In **Logical_test2,** select cell E2 and use the conditional <70 and **Value_if_true** Medium Risk
4. In **Logical_test3**, select cell E2 and use the statement TRUE to cover all remaining data and **Value_if_true** Low Risk
5. Click **OK** to populate the column

student_name	Attendance Status	Delivery Mode	Engagement Score Weekly	Engagement Risk Band	Student category
Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	Medium Risk
Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	Medium Risk
David Wilson	Present	On Campus	68	Medium	Medium Risk
Sarah Smith	Present	On Campus	82	Low	Low Risk
James Taylor	Authorised Absence	On Campus	83	Low	Low Risk
Lily Brown	Present	Remote	84	Low	Low Risk
Emily Clark	Absent	On Campus	91	Low	Low Risk
Daniel Green	Present	Hybrid	92	Low	Low Risk
Sophia White	Present	Hybrid	65	Medium	Medium Risk
Lucas Hall	Present	Remote	76	Low	Low Risk
Olivia King	Late	Remote	82	Low	Low Risk
Henry Scott	Present	On Campus	83	Low	Low Risk
Ava Turner	Present	On Campus	66	Medium	Medium Risk
Jack Hill	Present	Remote	63	Medium	Medium Risk
Mia Adams	Present	On Campus	86	Low	Low Risk
Noah Baker	Present	Remote	82	Low	Low Risk
Grace Nelson	Present	On Campus	93	Low	Low Risk
Leo Carter	Present	On Campus	76	Low	Low Risk
Ella Mitchell	Present	Remote	77	Low	Low Risk
Oscar Perez	Present	Remote	56	High	Medium Risk
Isla Roberts	Present	Hybrid	84	Low	Low Risk
Amelia Walker	Authorised Absence	On Campus	85	Low	Low Risk
Ethan Phillips	Present	Hybrid	76	Low	Low Risk
Freya Campbell	Present	Remote	69	Medium	Medium Risk
Benjamin Parker	Present	Remote	88	Low	Low Risk
Chloe Evans	Present	On Campus	94	Low	Low Risk
Arthur Edwards	Present	Hybrid	77	Low	Low Risk
Sienna Collins	Present	Remote	78	Low	Low Risk
Thomas Stewart	Present	Remote	79	Low	Low Risk
Evie Morris	Absent	Hybrid	70	Medium	Low Risk

What Excel is doing:

For each row:

1. Check: is score < 50?
    - If YES → “High Risk” (STOP)
2. If not, check: is score < 70?
    - If YES → “Medium Risk” (STOP)
3. If none match:
    - TRUE means “anything else” → “Low Risk”

SECTION 3 — IFS with text

Question 2

Categorise attendance:

- Absent → Concern
- Late → Monitor
- Otherwise → OK

What you do:

=IFS(
B2="Absent","Concern",
B2="Late","Monitor",
TRUE,"OK"
)

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	student_name	Attendance Status	Delivery Mode	Engagement Score Weekly	Engagement Risk Band	Student category	Attendance Category	
2	Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	Medium Risk	OK	
3	Ali Khan	Present	Remote	53	High	Medium Risk	OK	
4	David Wilson	Present	On Campus	68	Medium	Medium Risk	OK	
5	Sarah Smith	Present	On Campus	82	Low	Low Risk	OK	
6	James Taylor	Authorised Absence	On Campus	83	Low	Low Risk	OK	
7	Lily Brown	Present	Remote	84	Low	Low Risk	OK	
8	Emily Clark	Absent	On Campus	91	Low	Low Risk	Concern	
9	Daniel Green	Present	Hybrid	92	Low	Low Risk	OK	
10	Sophia White	Present	Hybrid	65	Medium	Medium Risk	OK	
11	Lucas Hall	Present	Remote	76	Low	Low Risk	OK	
12	Olivia King	Late	Remote	82	Low	Low Risk	Monitor	
13	Henry Scott	Present	On Campus	83	Low	Low Risk	OK	
14	Ava Turner	Present	On Campus	66	Medium	Medium Risk	OK	
15	Jack Hill	Present	Remote	63	Medium	Medium Risk	OK	
16	Mia Adams	Present	On Campus	86	Low	Low Risk	OK	
17	Noah Baker	Present	Remote	82	Low	Low Risk	OK	
18	Grace Nelson	Present	On Campus	93	Low	Low Risk	OK	
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20	Ella Mitchell	Present	Remote	77	Low	Low Risk	OK	
21	Oscar Perez	Present	Remote	56	High	Medium Risk	OK	
22	Isla Roberts	Present	Hybrid	84	Low	Low Risk	OK	
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27	Chloe Evans	Present	On Campus	94	Low	Low Risk	OK	
28	Arthur Edwards	Present	Hybrid	77	Low	Low Risk	OK	
29	Sienna Collins	Present	Remote	78	Low	Low Risk	OK	
30	Thomas Stewart	Present	Remote	79	Low	Low Risk	OK	
31	Evie Morris	Absent	Hybrid	70	Medium	Low Risk	Concern	
32								
33								
34								

What Excel is doing:

Excel checks the Attendance column
It goes step by step:

- Is it Absent? → Yes → “Concern”
- If not → is it Late? → Yes → “Monitor”
- If not → “OK”

SECTION 4 — Important rule (very important)

Order matters

Excel stops at the first match

Example:

```
=IFS(
E2<70,"Medium",
E2<50,"High",
TRUE,"Low"
)
```

❌ This is wrong

What happens:

- Score = 45
- First check: <70 → TRUE
  👉 It stops and gives “Medium” (wrong)

Correct order:

```
=IFS(
E2<50,"High",
E2<70,"Medium",
TRUE,"Low"
)
```

Always go **small** → **large**

Final Summary

What Excel is doing every time:

- It looks at one row
- It checks conditions one by one
- It stops at the first true condition
- It returns that result

The difference from IF:

- IF → one decision
- IFS → multiple decisions

The simplest way to remember:

> IFS = “Check this, if not check this, if not check this”

Final note

If you get stuck:

> “Excel is checking each rule in order until one works”